Problem-Solution fit canvas 2.0

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

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Define CS, fit into CC

1. CUSTOMER SEGMENT(S) — CS

Who is your customer?
i.e. working parents of 0-5 y.o. kids

- Employees and new joiners who need a standard laptop (new hire, replacement or refresh)
- IT procurement / service desk team who process the orders
- Reporting managers who approve laptop requests
- Procurement, finance and vendor teams who fulfil the purchase

6. CUSTOMER CONSTRAINTS — CC

What constraints prevent your customers from taking action or limit their choices of solutions? i.e. spending power, budget, no cash, network connection, available devices.

- Budget limits and approval thresholds for hardware spend
- Only approved standard models and vendors can be ordered
- Stock availability and vendor delivery lead times
- Security and compliance policies; access to the ITSM platform is needed
- Approvals depend on the availability of managers

5. AVAILABLE SOLUTIONS — AS

Which solutions are available to the customers when they face the problem or need to get the job done? What have they tried in the past? What pros & cons do these solutions have? i.e. pen and paper is an alternative to digital notetaking

- Email, phone calls and spreadsheets to raise and track laptop requests
- Manually handled tickets with manual approvals and manual purchase orders
- Pros: familiar, flexible for one-off requests
- Cons: slow, error-prone, no real-time tracking, inconsistent process, high repetitive effort for IT

Explore AS, differentiate

Focus on J&P, tap into BE, understand RC

2. JOBS-TO-BE-DONE / PROBLEMS — J&P

Which jobs-to-be-done (or problems) do you address for your customers?
There could be more than one; explore different sides.

- Employees: request a standard laptop quickly and know its status without chasing
- Managers: review and approve requests easily in one place
- IT team: remove repetitive manual steps for routine laptop orders and reduce errors
- Organisation: faster onboarding, policy compliance and a clear audit trail

9. PROBLEM ROOT CAUSE — RC

What is the real reason that this problem exists?
What is the back story behind the need to do this job?
i.e. customers have to do it because of the change in regulations.

- Standard laptop orders follow the same steps every time, yet each request is still processed by hand
- Approval, stock check, purchase order and notification steps are disconnected across emails and tools
- No automated workflow (Flow Designer) exists to connect these steps end to end
- Growing order volume increases delays and manual workload for IT

7. BEHAVIOUR — BE

What does your customer do to address the problem and get the job done? i.e. directly related: find the right solar panel installer, calculate usage and benefits; indirectly associated: customers spend free time on volunteering work (i.e. Greenpeace)

- Employee raises a request by email, phone or ticket and follows up repeatedly
- IT checks stock and policy manually, then forwards the request for approval
- IT raises the purchase order and updates the requester by hand
- Indirectly: employees wait on an old device or ask colleagues for updates

Focus on J&P, tap into BE, understand RC

Identify strong TR & EM

3. TRIGGERS — TR

What triggers customers to act? i.e. seeing their neighbour installing solar panels, reading about a more efficient solution in the news.

- New hire joining; laptop failure or end of life
- Repeated delays and follow-ups; management push for efficiency

4. EMOTIONS: BEFORE / AFTER — EM

How do customers feel when they face a problem or a job and afterwards? i.e. lost, insecure > confident, in control - use it in your communication strategy & design.

- Before: frustrated, uncertain, impatient (no visibility)
- After: confident, in control, satisfied

10. YOUR SOLUTION — SL

If you are working on an existing business, write down your current solution first, fill in the canvas, and check how much it fits reality.
If you are working on a new business proposition, then keep it blank until you fill in the canvas and come up with a solution that fits within customer limitations, solves a problem and matches customer behaviour.

- Automate standard laptop orders with Flow Designer
- Flow triggers when a request is submitted from the service catalog
- Auto-validates the request against policy and routes it for approval
- On approval: checks inventory or creates the procurement task / purchase order
- Automatically notifies the requester at each stage and updates the status
- Closes the request on delivery; IT handles only exceptions

8. CHANNELS of BEHAVIOUR — CH

8.1 ONLINE
What kind of actions do customers take online? Extract online channels from #7

- Submit request via self-service portal; approve online; track status; email/portal notifications

8.2 OFFLINE
What kind of actions do customers take offline? Extract offline channels from #7 and use them for customer development.

- Ask the service desk in person or by phone; manager verbal go-ahead; physical laptop handover and asset tagging

Extract online & offline CH of BE

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